

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It would be nice to live on a quiet street!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How would you feel about living in a very quiet area of a city or town?
- What might people who moved to a quiet place miss about living in a noisy, active city?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can talk about what had been happening.
- I can refer to or report a past action, talk about an unreal past situation, or express an action in progress in the past.





Let's Explore!

Marc had a small **pension***.

* A "*pension*" is money you get monthly after you retire.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Marc Girondin was glad to have received a small inheritance from his parents. When he had last spoken to his superior, he had said he had been wanting to retire early. So, after 20 years, Marc had been given a small party and a small pension. He was free. He had been wanting to entirely devote himself fully to his new life on Green Bottle Street, the street that didn't exist, and that's just what he did.

Marc had moved into the top floor of Sara's house and begun a new existence. His days were spent sitting in the garden chatting with Sara, and playing chess with Mr. Hazard and Mr. Desselin. They'd been living on the street for years.

His previous life working at City Hall and living in the old noisy apartment had been completely forgotten. Marc had delighted in his new life from the beginning. He started organizing activities for all residents of Green Bottle Street. They'd been sharing trips to the post office and grocery store since he arrived. Life was perfect and equitable for all Green Bottle residents.

The years there seemed to have passed by quickly when Marc found that there were few residents left on Green Bottle Street. He was glad to have been living his life every day that went by. He would have hated to have gone back to the outside world to stay.

Mr. Desselin, who had been getting on, was glad to have been asked to live with family in a warmer city. Mr. Hazard had gone to a seniors' home. The homes were now thought to be badly in need of repair. Marc, ever resourceful, had been holding on to something for this very day.

It was thought to have been a mistake at first. It was a card that had been sitting, wedged at the back of the middle drawer. He'd found it on his final day 15 years ago. Circle Street, it had read. He had been there just last month to check it out. Another mislaid street was waiting for them on the other side of town.





Let's Practice!

Marc is living out his dream.

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. When you complete the sentences, read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. Marc Girondin was glad to
2. The years there seemed to
3. He was glad to have been
4. He would have hated to
5. Mr. Desselin was glad to have been
6. The homes were now thought
7. It was thought to have

COLUMN B

- a. have passed by quickly when Marc found that there were few residences left on Green Bottle Street.
- b. have gone back to the outside world to stay.
- c. living his life every day that went by.
- d. asked to live with family in a warmer city.
- e. to be badly in need of repair.
- f. have received a small inheritance from his parents.
- g. been a mistake at first.



Let's Practice!

Marc is off to another quest.

Instructions: Write the correct form of the verb in parenthesis.

1. When he had last _____ (to speak) to his superior, he had been wanting to retire early.
2. They had been _____ (to live) on the street for years.
3. He had _____ (to start) activities for all residents of Green Bottle Street.
4. They had been _____ (to share) trips to the post office and grocery store since he arrived.
5. Mr. Desselin, who had been _____ (to get) on, was glad to have been asked to live with family in a warmer city.
6. It was a card that had been _____ (to sit) wedged at the back of the middle drawer.





Extension Activity

Compare two places to live.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about living in a quiet place and a noisy urban area.
- Make notes on the pros and cons of living in each type of area and what type of person is best suited to live there.
- Write 200 words.
- Describe the areas and state both sides of living there.
- Decide which type of place is best for you and explain why.
- Read your writing to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write about the pros and cons of living in a quiet area or a noisy urban area.

☐ ☐

I describe what each area is like and the type of person best suited to live there.

☐ ☐

I explain which area is best for me and why.

☐ ☐

I share my writing with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- inheritance** (noun): money, land, or possessions received from someone after they have died
e.g. Marc Girondin was glad to have received a small inheritance from his parents.
- to delight in** (verb): to feel great satisfaction, pleasure, and happiness
e.g. Marc had delighted in his new life from the beginning.
- equitable** (adjective): fair and even
e.g. Life was perfect and equitable for all Green Bottle residents.
- resident** (noun): a person who lives somewhere long-term
e.g. He'd started organizing activities for all residents of Green Bottle Street.
- senior** (noun): an older person, at retirement age
e.g. Mr. Hazard had gone to a seniors home.
- to wedge** (verb): to force into a narrow space
e.g. It was a card that had been sitting, wedged at the back of the middle drawer.
- mislaidd** (adjective): unintentionally put something where it cannot easily be found
e.g. Another mislaidd street was waiting for them on the other side of town.





Learning Points

Uses of the Past Perfect Continuous

You use the Past Perfect Continuous to talk about an action in progress before another past time. There are three more particular ways to use the Past Perfect Continuous tense.

1. to talk about an action in progress that finished at a specific time in the past

For example:

*We'd **been walking** for about an hour when my leg suddenly cramped up.*
(The action of walking stopped when the leg cramped up)

1. to talk about an action in progress that continued beyond a specific time in the past

For example:

*He felt terrible during the show because he **had been suffering** from the flu since the day before.*
(The action of suffering continues before and after the interview)

1. to talk about an action in progress that finished shortly before a specific time in the past

For example:

*When I last saw you, you **had been jogging** and were sweating.*

Examples:

- *When he had last spoken to his superior, he said **had been wanting** to retire early.*
- *He **had been wanting** to entirely devote himself fully to his new life on Green Bottle Street, the street that didn't exist, and that's just what he did.*
- *His days were spent sitting in the garden chatting with Sara, and playing chess with Mr. Hazard and Mr. Desselin.*
- *They'd **been living** on the street for years.*
- *His previous life working at City Hall and living in the old noisy apartment had been completely forgotten.*
- *He'd **started organizing** activities for all residents of Green Bottle Street.*
- *They'd **been sharing** trips to the post office and grocery store since he arrived.*
- *Mr. Desselin, who **had been getting on**, was glad to have been asked to live with family in a warmer city.*
- *It was a card that **had been sitting**, wedged at the back of the middle drawer.*





Learning Points

Perfect Infinitives vs. Perfect Continuous Infinitive

The Infinitive can have different forms depending on the tense of the preceding verb and the context of the conversation or writing. The infinitive is dependent on the preceding verbs as it can have no tense of its own.

Let's look at the Perfect Infinitives and the Perfect Continuous Infinitive:

	Active	Passive
Perfect Infinitive	to have discovered	to have been discovered
Perfect Continuous Infinitive	to have been discovering	to have been being discovered

The Perfect Infinitive refers to a time before the preceding verb.

For example:

*I'm happy **to have completed** my course.*

*They **were** assumed **to have completed** the course.*

The Perfect Continuous Infinitive refers to a time before that of the preceding verb and expresses an action in progress or happening over a period of time.

For example:

*I'm glad **to have been studying** at this school for the past 3 years.*

*The employees **were** thought **to have been preparing** for the presentation for days.*

Examples:

- *Marc Girondin was glad to have received a small inheritance from his parents.*
- *The years there seemed to have passed by quickly when Marc found that there were few residents left on Green Bottle Street.*
- *He was glad to have been living his life every day that went by.*
- *He would have hated to have gone back to the outside world to stay.*
- *Mr. Desselin, who had been getting on, was glad to have been asked to live with family in a warmer city.*
- *The homes were now thought to be badly in need of repair.*
- *It was thought to have been a mistake at first.*

